

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

Preparation of the 11th Consultation

Combating discrimination in education

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION

1. Introduction

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

2. Scope of the Consultation

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**¹ (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**², which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**³, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**⁴ which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education⁵ and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.⁶

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

¹ <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

² <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

³ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf

⁴ https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf

⁵ [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/marrakech-framework-for-action)

⁶ [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022)

4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**⁷ in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**⁸, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database⁹. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

⁷ <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

⁸ <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

⁹ [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](https://uis.unesco.org)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: **Slovak Republic**

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:

Ministry of Education, Research, Development and Youth of the Slovak Republic

Name of contact person:

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I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education¹⁰

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?¹¹

☐ No

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.

II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.

*It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “**ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all**” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.¹²*

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☒ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

The Ministry of Education, Research, Development and Youth of the Slovak Republic prepared several projects and publications that are covering the topic of inclusive schools. More details can be seen: <https://www.minedu.sk/specialne-a-inkluzivne-vzdelavanie/>

At the moment there is a formal procedure ongoing to settle a new legislation for lifelong learning and adult education, Adult Education Act: <https://www.minedu.sk/ministerstvo-skolstva-pripravilo-novy-zakon-o-vzdelavani-dospelych/>

¹¹ Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

¹² Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation¹³, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b¹⁴

☐ Legal texts¹⁵ prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education:

- ☒ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☒ In primary education
- ☒ In secondary education
- ☒ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☒ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

§ 3 letter f) and § 144 Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training (school law) and on the amendment of some laws.

Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training and on the amendment of some laws – § 3 letters (d), (f), (g).

Education and training under this Act shall be based on the principles of:

(d) equality of access to education and training, considering the educational needs of the individual and his/her co-responsibility for his/her education

(f) the prohibition of all forms of discrimination and, in particular, segregation

(g) the equivalence and indivisibility of education and training in the educational process.

§55 art. 2 Act on higher education

<https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2002/131/20230101>

Act No. 413/2021 Coll. amending Act No. 61/2015 Coll. on Vocational Education and Training and on Amendments and Additions to Certain Acts - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2021/413/20220101.html>

¹³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

¹⁴ Which calls on states to "substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes".

¹⁵ Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

Segregation, educational needs, abilities and possibilities, talent and state of health.

Age, sex, sexual orientation, race, marital status, colour, health disability, language, political ideas, ethnicity, religion, membership in labour union, national or social background, wealth, gender or other status.

Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training and on the amendment of some laws – § 3 letters (d), (f), (g).

Education and training under this Act shall be based on the principles of:

(d) equality of access to education and training, considering the educational needs of the individual and his/her co-responsibility for his/her education

(f) the prohibition of all forms of discrimination and, in particular, segregation

(g) the equivalence and indivisibility of education and training in the educational process.

☒ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

- ☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☐ In primary education
- X In secondary education
- X In technical and vocational education and training
- ☐ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on Education and Training and on the Amendment of some laws - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2008/245/20240601>

Projects from Program Slovakia dedicated to the theme anti-discrimination and inclusive schools. Details can be found: <https://www.itms2014.sk/vyzva>. Examples of projects: Catching-up regions; Support for mental health and prevention children, pupils and students; Centres of excellency VET ect.

☒ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

- X In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- X In primary education
- X In secondary education
- X In technical and vocational education and training

- ☐ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

In the consolidated version of the National Curriculum (2023), under CHARACTER section, Component 3: Bravery, it states "At the end of Cycle 2, the student is able to:

(b) notice instances of exclusion of others or injustice and name possible solutions.

Component 5: Respect for Others, it states that at the end of Cycle 2, the student is able to:

a) respect different opinions, people's perspectives and competing ideas from different backgrounds and value the input of others in working together,

b) be interested in the well-being of others, noticing their visible needs.

6. Component: Justice, it states: at the end of Cycle 2, the student is able to:

(a) know ethical concepts such as justice, honesty, equality, respect, tolerance and distinguish between right and wrong actions even in less familiar contexts.

At the end of Cycle 3, the student is able to:

(b) make decisions and act also on the basis of consideration of the consequences for the wider group or community,

c) act with integrity and make decisions based on beliefs about the rightness of moral principles, regardless of public scrutiny.

In the consolidated version of the National Curriculum (2023), in the section Human and society it is stated: It enables understanding of geographical, historical, cultural, religious, economic and political specificities in different parts of the world, which leads to respect and consideration for other people, cultures and spiritual values, such as also towards each other. It strengthens students' active attitude towards solving current challenges and problems. An important part of the civic component is education to active citizenship, respect for the principles of freedom and democracy, as well as to the protection of human rights. The ethical-personality component contributes to the personal, social and moral development of students, with an emphasis on awareness, acceptance and development of one's own identity in relation to other people and everything alive on our planet. Cultivating the character, moral and spiritual qualities of students is an integral part of these processes.

The theme discrimination is discussed in several subjects in curriculum for high schools and VET schools. For example: Náuka o spoločnosti, Slovak Language and Literature, Ethics etc.

Link to the curriculum for VET schools: <https://siov.sk/vzdelavanie/odborne-vzdelavanie-a-priprava/>

Link to the curriculum for high schools: <https://nivam.sk/dokumenty-institucie/>

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

General measures:

☒ Legislation provides for inclusive education for all

☒ Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all

☒ Teachers are trained on inclusive education¹⁶ and to value diversity

☒ Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance

☐ Other:

☒ Multiple and flexible learning pathways¹⁷ are provided for

☒ Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design¹⁸

☒ Multilingual and intercultural education is supported

Schools were obliged to organize updating education in the 2022/2023 in the scope of at least 20 hours per school year, while the content was focused on changes to the school curriculum, inclusive education or digitalisation. Link: [Providers of innovative education for teachers in the field of inclusion](#)

¹⁶ Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

¹⁷ Multiple and flexible learning pathways are 'entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education' ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

¹⁸ In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Act No. 245/2008 Coll. on Education and Training and on the Amendment of some laws - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2008/245/20240601>

Act No. 413/2021 Coll. amending Act No. 61/2015 Coll. on Vocational Education and Training and amending and supplementing certain acts - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2021/413/20220101.html>

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for gender equality in education | ☐ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality | ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for |
| ☐ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken | ☒ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities ²⁰ |
| ☐ Providing positive or affirmative action measures | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²¹ and bias |
| ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality | ☒ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET) |
| ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ¹⁹ | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

Act No. 245/2008 Coll. on Education and Training and on the Amendment of some laws - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2008/245/20240601>

¹⁹ ‘ Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

²⁰ ‘ Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal’ ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

²¹ Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong’ (Cambridge Dictionary).

Act No. 413/2021 Coll. amending Act No. 61/2015 Coll. on Vocational Education and Training and on Amendments of some laws - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2021/413/20220101.html>

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) ²²:

Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

National minorities:

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☒ Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities | ☒ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁴ |
| ☒ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☒ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities | ☒ Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities |
| ☒ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities | ☒ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities |

²² Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

²⁴ Supra note 15.

☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities

☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes²⁵ and bias

☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities

☐ Other²³:

Multilingual and intercultural education are supported through Erasmus+ Programme.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

At the national level, the legal basis for the development of national minority education in the Slovak Republic is primarily the Constitution of the Slovak Republic, in particular Article 34; Article 7(5); Article 12; Article 33 and Article 42, in conjunction with the international documents of the European Charter for Regional or Minority Languages and the Framework Convention for the Protection of National Minorities. The right to upbringing and education of members of national minorities is regulated and specified primarily by Act No. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training (School Act) and on the amendment of some laws as amended. Other laws governing the relevant area are: Act No. 596/2003 Coll. on state administration in education and school self-administration and on the amendment and addition of certain laws as amended; Act No. 597/2003 Coll. on the financing of elementary schools, secondary schools and school facilities, as amended; Act No. 138/2019 Coll. on pedagogic employees and professional employees and on the amendment of some laws and a whole range of secondary legislation. Education and training according the School Act are among others based on the principle of equality of access to education and training, taking into account the educational needs of the individual and his co-responsibility for his education, inclusive education, prohibition of all forms of discrimination and especially segregation, equality and inseparability of upbringing and education in the educational process, preparation for a responsible life in a free society in the spirit of understanding and tolerance, equality between men and women, friendship between people, national and ethnic groups and religious tolerance. In 2021, the Ministry of Education prepared an amendment to the School Act No. 245/2008, which introduced the definition of national minority education into the law (Act No. 415/2021 Coll.).

The school system of the Slovak Republic is set up in such a way that an equal and inseparable part of the educational system of the Slovak Republic is the upbringing and education of national minorities in their mother tongue and the teaching of the mother tongue, including its institutional provision by schools and school facilities with the language of instruction of the national minority and with the teaching of the language of the national minority. Education and training in the language of a national minority creates conditions for the development of national minorities in the area of preserving and developing their identity, language, culture and traditions. According to Article 3(1) of the European Charter for Regional or Minority Languages in the Slovak Republic, "regional or minority languages"

²³ Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

²⁵ Supra note 16.

in the Slovak Republic are: 1. Bulgarian, 2. Czech, 3. Croatian, 4. German, 5. Hungarian, 6. Polish, 7. Romani, 8. Ruthenian and 9. Ukrainian.

In Slovakia, there are more than 15 schools where the language of the national minority is taught (schools with teaching either Romani, Ukrainian or German language as a language of the minority) and there are also more national minority schools with the language of instruction of the national minority (more than 500 schools with Hungarian language of instruction - kindergartens, elementary schools and secondary schools; 4 kindergartens and 2 elementary schools with Ruthenian language of instruction; 1 kindergarten, elementary and secondary school with Ukrainian language of instruction; and 150 schools with Slovak and also Hungarian language of instruction). Part of education and training in elementary and secondary schools with a language of instruction other than the state language is also the compulsory subject Slovak language and literature to the extent of teaching necessary for its acquisition, or the subject Slovak language and Slovak literature, which is taught using methods and forms of upbringing and education as a foreign language. The language of instruction in which the subject is taught is also the language in which the examination and monitoring and evaluation of the quality of education and training are carried out.

In the national minority schools, upbringing and education are implemented according to educational programs that respect the specifics of the educational needs of the national minorities. Part of the state educational programs are framework curricula in which the minimum hourly allowance for the language and literature of national minorities is defined within general education subjects. Educational standards have been developed for teaching the subjects of: Bulgarian, Czech, Croatian, German, Hungarian, Polish, Romani, Russian, Ruthenian and Ukrainian language and literature. An addendum to the educational standards for teaching the subjects of history and music in elementary and secondary schools with the teaching language of the national minorities was also developed. Through these subjects, students gradually learn the history of their nation in the context of learning about the history of the Slovak nation and other national and social groups. This cultivates their historical consciousness and enables the realization of their constitutional right to preserve and develop their cultural and linguistic identity.

At departments and institutes of higher education institutions, it is possible to take university courses in which several languages of national minorities are taught, namely Bulgarian, Croatian, German, Hungarian, Polish, Romani, Russian, Ruthenian and Ukrainian. In Slovakia, the Selye János University in Komárno remains the only independent public higher education institution where teaching takes place primarily in the language of the national minority - in the Hungarian language. With this, it secures continuous education and training in Hungarian language from kindergarten to university.

The Ministry of Education in Slovakia has a separate National Minority and Inclusive Education Department. One of the main goals of the department is to ensure quality education of national minorities whose members live on the territory of the Slovak Republic, to monitor, analyse and evaluate the education in the languages of national minorities and to cooperate with The Office of the Plenipotentiary of the Slovak Government for National Minorities and nationality schools.

The Slovak Republic provides positive affirmative action measures for national minority education: ensures the financial and professional prerequisites for the preservation and more efficient operation of nationality schools by increased financial norms for schools with the language of instruction and schools with the teaching the subject of a national minority, increased financial standards for educational publication, ensures a free choice of educational publications and materials available in the language of the national minority if

they are in accordance with the valid state educational program, ensures professional development for teaching staff and professional staff who educate children and pupils belonging to national minorities and ethnic groups through educational programs and professional events (about inclusive education, teaching methods for first and second languages etc.), ensures bilingual documentation for nationality schools (namely in the state language and in the language of the relevant national minority); coordinates nationwide competitions for pupils belonging to national minorities and ethnic groups; recognizes diplomas obtained abroad in case of content compliance, announces project calls for nationality school development projects with priority areas of activities shaping the relationship of pupils to their national identity, history, culture, traditions and activities contributing to the coexistence of children of various national minorities and the majority.

The Ministry of Education is implementing a pilot project together with the Council of Europe in the period 2022-2025 entitled "ROMANI-PLURILINGUAL POLICY EXPERIMENTATION" (RPPE). Primary schools from 3 countries of the European Union are involved in the project: Slovakia, Slovenia and Greece. The implementation of the RPPE is planned for three school years: 2022/2023, 2023/2024, 2024/2025. The RPPE aims to explore ways of using Roma language and culture to further the inclusion of Roma pupils in education. The activities are shaped by two principles that underpin the work of the Council of Europe in the field of language education: 1) pupils of all ages are at the same time language users, social actors with their own agendas to fulfil, and 2) language education should take into account all the languages present in a given educational context and help pupils to develop an integrated plurilingual repertoire and intercultural awareness.

The Ministry of Education was implementing a project "Innovative training of teachers with the aim of increasing their intercultural competence in the educational process of Roma students", known under the slogan "Together with the Roma we will achieve more" until 2024. The aim of the project was the systemic support of schools with pupils from Roma communities with the introduction of the teaching of the Roma language and literature in formal and informal education. All project activities aimed at supporting intercultural education and building a democratic and inclusive school environment. Cooperation was established also with teachers who have successfully completed the state exam in the Romani language.

In 2023, the Ministry of Education in Slovakia prepared a Program of Changes containing 39 points, the aim of which is to contribute to improving the state of education in Slovakia. Each of the mentioned 39 points is developed into separate projects within the framework of project management with the aim of fulfilling the obligations of the Program Statement of the Government of the Slovak Republic for the years 2023-2027. One of the projects of the Program of Changes is the Project Opportunity for all children, the aim of which is to ensure that all children in Slovakia, after completing their education, have the opportunity to find a job and lead a dignified and fulfilling adult life. The main goal is to increase the quality of education of children from an environment of generational poverty, with a health disadvantage, or otherwise disadvantaged pupils and to ensure the application of inclusive measures so that the educational needs of national minorities are also respected. The area of development of national education is covered in many projects arising from the program statement of the Government, whether it concerns the provision of an effective system of support measures, increasing the quality and quantity of textbooks and other educational resources, the effective implementation of curriculum reform in primary and secondary schools, the development of pedagogical and professional staff, or improving the mental health of pupils, for example also the standardization of diagnostic materials in the language

of national minorities. In many projects, organizations and experts from national minorities cooperate as external partners.

A mandatory part of the educational content are cross-cutting themes, which usually overlap across educational areas. Cross-cutting topics can be applied as an integrated part of the educational content of the appropriate teaching subjects or as a separate subject within optional lessons. The choice of method and time of implementation of cross-cutting topics is within the competence of each school. At the level of primary education, the State Education Program introduces the following cross-cutting topics: Personal and social development, Environmental education, Media education, Multicultural education, Protection of life and health, and Regional education and traditional folk culture. Multicultural education is included in the content of education with regard to the Slovak cultural environment, where members of different ethnic, national, religious and cultural origins have lived together for centuries. At the same time, traditional cultural diversity is currently deepening thanks to several trends that are often covered by the term globalization. The goal of the cross-cutting topic multicultural education is therefore educational action aimed at developing knowledge of various traditional and new cultures and subcultures, acceptance of cultural diversity as a social reality and development of tolerance, respect and prosocial behaviour and actions in relation to cultural differences. Multicultural education can naturally be integrated into humanities and social science subjects. However, the elements of multicultural education can be developed in terms of content and methodology or with the help of suitable examples in natural science subjects or in the teaching of languages.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Indigenous people:

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people |
| ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people | ☒ Teachers are trained on intercultural education |
| ☐ Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ²⁶ |
| ☐ The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | ☒ Multilingual and intercultural education are supported |
| ☐ Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people | ☐ Native language instruction is ensured |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people | ☐ Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ²⁷ and bias |

²⁶ Supra note 15.

²⁷ Supra note 16.

☐ Other:

Multilingual and intercultural education are mainly supported through Erasmus+ Programme.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations²⁸:

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☐ Multiple and flexible learning pathways ³¹ are provided |
| ☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³² and bias |
| ☐ All administrative barriers to access education are removed | ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided |
| ☒ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers ²⁹ are provided for | ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided |
| ☒ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion | ☒ Language classes to newcomers are provided for |
| ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³⁰ | ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged |
| ☐ Other: | |

Link: [Education of children and pupils of foreigners](#)

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

²⁸ 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

²⁹ While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

³⁰ Supra note 15.

³¹ Supra note 13

³² Supra note 16.

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

People with disabilities:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Legislation provides for their right to education | ☒ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities – partially |
| ☒ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education | ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation ³³ |
| ☒ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured | ☒ Auxiliary assistance is provided |
| ☒ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools | ☒ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted |
| ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided | ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes ³⁴ and bias |
| ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided | ☒ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted |
| ☐ Other | |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

For example, § 145a and §145b of Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training and on the amendment of some laws.

Scholarships for talented students from socially disadvantaged background. Preparation of call for support centres at universities. Meals and accommodation are paid by students, but ministry provides funding to decrease the price.

Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on Education and Training and on the Amendment of some laws - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2008/245/20240601>

³³ Supra note 15.

³⁴ Supra note 16.

Act No. 413/2021 Coll. amending Act No. 61/2015 Coll. on Vocational Education and Training and on Amendments and Additions to Certain Acts - <https://www.slov-lex.sk/pravne-predpisy/SK/ZZ/2021/413/20220101.html>

All details about special and inclusive education are available here: <https://www.minedu.sk/specialne-a-inkluzivne-vzdelavanie/>

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Funds

Students from poor households:

- ☒ Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided
- ☒ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation³⁵
- ☒ Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education
- ☒ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes³⁶ and bias
- ☒ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

For example, § 145a par. 2 letters Act No. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training and on the amendment of some laws.

Link - [Slovak republic provides financial subsidy for students from poor households for meals and educational materials.](#)

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

Funds

³⁵ Supra note 15.

³⁶ Supra note 16.

2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

2.1 Early childhood care and education

For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation³⁷ and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education³⁸. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (*several items may be ticked*):

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☒ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free | ☒ ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, foundational learning, responsive care, nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play. |
| ☐ Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable | |
| ☐ ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis | |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

Childcare facilities that precede pre-primary education for children aged 0-3 years, known as nurseries, fall under the Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs and Family of the Slovak Republic, i.e. we have no information and data.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

X Pre-primary education is compulsory.

Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

5 years old, 1 year is compulsory

Enrolment and duration of pre-primary education is from 5-6 years. Compulsory and free pre-primary education in the Slovak Republic is from the age of 5 years.

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.

X Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:

Yes, but only compulsory pre-primary education from 5-6 years is free.

³⁷ Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.
³⁸ Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

☐ Limited access

☒ Poor learning outcomes

☒ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ Low number of professionally trained educators

☐ Poor quality programmes

☒ Lack of support to families

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.2 Primary and secondary education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”

Primary education

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

From 6 to 16 years.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

☒ Primary education is compulsory

☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Primary education is free of charge.

☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies,

uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Limited access | ☒ Poor learning outcomes in: |
| ☒ Issues of equity and inclusion | Foundation literacy |
| ☐ High dropout rates | Numeracy |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | Social and emotional learning |
| ☐ Other: | Others |
| | ☒ Disparity in learning outcomes |
| | ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers |

Act no. 245/2008 Coll. on education and training and on the amendment of some laws.

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

PISA results for recent years.

Secondary education

In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

The pupil will finish lower secondary education after successful graduation from second stage of primary school (after 9 years) or successful finishing the first year of 5 years gymnasium (type of high school) or after finishing 4th year of 8-year gymnasium. Usually this happens at the age of 16.

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

The pupil will gain upper secondary education after successful graduation from high school or VET school where she/he would successfully pass the final exam and receive certificate of education degree (ECR) and the certificate of qualification. Usually this happens at the age of 19.

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

☒ Lower secondary education is compulsory.

☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Lower secondary education is free of charge.

☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.

☐ Upper secondary education is compulsory.

☒ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.

☒ Upper secondary education is free of charge

☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.

Yes o No o

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

☐ Limited access

☒ Poor learning outcomes

☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☒ Low readiness of primary graduates

☒ High dropout rates

☒ Low number of professionally trained teachers

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.3 Higher education

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3³⁹, and target 4.4⁴⁰. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☒ Higher education is free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☒ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☐ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

Scholarships for talented students from socially disadvantaged background.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

³⁹ Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

⁴⁰ Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

- ☐ Limited access
- ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion
- ☐ Poor quality programmes
- ☐ Poor learning outcomes
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors
- ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☒ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education
- ☒ Provision of literacy programmes
- ☒ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)
- ☒ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities
- ☒ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes
- ☒ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning
- ☒ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling
- ☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.
- ☐ Other:

[VET in Europe database | Vocational education and training in Europe | Slovakia | CEDEFOP \(europa.eu\)](#)

[Lifelong learning strategy \(europa.eu\)](#)

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

National project was approved: Link - [Systém individuálnych vzdelávacích účtov – časť I: Elektronická platforma individuálnych vzdelávacích účtov \(EPIVU\)](#) to support lifelong learning in Slovakia.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Limited access | ☒ Limited funding |
| ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion | ☐ Poor learning outcomes |
| ☐ Poor quality programmes | ☐ Low number of professionally trained educators |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3. Quality education provision and learning environment

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.

3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- X State monitoring and inspections
- X Health and sanitation
- X Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- X Infrastructure
- X Curriculum
- X Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees (if relevant)

☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

☐ Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments

☐ Violence in schools

☐ Cost of education

☐ Conflicts or crises

☐ Other:

☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

☐ Inadequate parental support to education

☐ Long distances to schools

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.2 Education personnel

For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

☒ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.

☐ Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).

☒ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.

☒ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.

☒ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.

☐ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.

☒ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.

☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

☐ Shortages of teaching staff

☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

☐ Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff

☐ High student – teacher ratio

☐ Lack of training centres

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.⁴¹ Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

☒ Curriculum includes human rights education.

☒ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.

☐ Other:

⁴¹

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

All types of curriculum are covering the theme of human rights. There are several subjects dedicated to this theme: social studies and Ethics or on the other hand, this theme is also covered in cross-cutting education within various subjects: history, Slovak language and literature, geography etc.

In Slovakia there are several extracurricular activities that are covering the theme of human rights: Olympics of human rights (since 1998), different types of schools' competitions, seminars and various types of activities provided by NGO.

3.4 Non-state actors in education

For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision⁴².

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation⁴³ explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

☐ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. Please specify what is covered:

- ☐ Registration
- ☐ State monitoring and inspections

⁴² Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

⁴³ See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

- ☐ Qualifications of teachers
- ☐ Health and sanitation
- ☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☐ Infrastructure
- ☐ Curriculum
- ☐ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees
- ☐ School closures
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials | ☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion |
| ☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers | ☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity |
| ☐ High student – teacher ratio | |
| ☐ Other: | |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

3.5 Digital education

Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion⁴⁴.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

- ☒ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

⁴⁴ Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

Act No. 245/2008 on Education and training and on the amendment of some laws mentions that the aim of education is also to enable a child or pupil to acquire competences in the use of digital technologies.

- ☒ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)
- ☒ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.
- ☒ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content⁴⁵, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.
- ☐ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.
- ☒ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education
- ☐ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.
- ☐ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

Following the adoption of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data, the Ministry created for the directly managed organisations of the ministry, higher education institutions and schools and school Facilities in Regional Education has developed the following [HYPERLINK "https://www.minedu.sk/ochrana-osobnych-udajov-v-rezorte-skolstva/"](https://www.minedu.sk/ochrana-osobnych-udajov-v-rezorte-skolstva/) [Recommendation Guideline](#).

The Ministry has prepared [HYPERLINK "https://www.minedu.sk/digiedu/"](https://www.minedu.sk/digiedu/) [a model of the School Digital Equipment Standard](#), which is based on the draft model for the European Commission Highly Equipped and Connected Classrooms (HECC). The aim of this model is not to exhaustively list the compulsory equipment of each school, but to set a standard of technological equipment for primary and secondary schools that should be achieved and maintained for the needs of a successful digital transformation of education.

[HYPERLINK "https://www.minedu.sk/vzdelavacia-a-informacna-platforma-viki/"](https://www.minedu.sk/vzdelavacia-a-informacna-platforma-viki/) [The Viki educational and information platform](#) is the Central Repository of Digital Educational Content

of the Ministry of Education CUDEO for kindergartens, primary and secondary schools, including grammar schools (for principals, teaching staff and pupils). This multi-modal national platform is free of charge for schools, teachers, and students. It contains interactive content for all of the subjects and even in different languages – Slovak, Rusyn, Hungarian, and Romani.

HYPERLINK "<https://vzdelavanie21.sk/>" [The new curricular reform](#) also promotes the inclusion of future-ready skills in education.

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | ☒ Limited access to internet and/or electricity |
| ☐ Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions | ☒ Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.) |
| ☐ Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks | ☒ Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions |
| ☐ Other: | ☒ Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale |
| | ☐ Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice |
| | ☐ Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

The Ministry of Education conducted a questionnaire survey in June 2021, which focused on finding out the real gap in the technical equipment of schools in Slovakia. More than 86% of primary and secondary schools participated in the survey. According to the findings of the survey, in 2024, the level of equipment in primary and secondary schools was almost 77% for personal computers, 64% for laptops, less than 27% for tablets and just under 8% for 2-in-1 convertible devices. More than half of the technical equipment was considered obsolete by schools. More than 97% of schools in Slovakia had access to wireless internet connectivity in 2021, but overall coverage was still insufficient. On average, less than 15% of schools had 100 percent Wi-Fi coverage.

In 2022-2023, schools were equipped from the European Structural Funds. HYPERLINK "<https://www.minedu.sk/pribeh-a-realizacia-projektu/>" [Information on the number of equipment delivered](#). HYPERLINK "<https://www.minedu.sk/digiedu/>" [Further equipment](#) will be provided from the Recovery Plan. Plans for sustainable financing and the provision of additional technical equipment have not yet been published.

Currently, there is an ongoing debate about the use of technologies (particularly mobile phones) at schools. The ministry has set up an expert group to discuss modification of current rules in relation to smartphone use at schools as a response to PISA 2023 results.

4 Strengthening governance systems

For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☐ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. [Please provide the link:](#)

☐ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☐ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

☐ Budgetary constraints

☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels

☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment

☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data

☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources

☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments

☐ Other: